U. S. 561, 575 (1943), "'subjecting themselves to the mental and physical hazards as well as the economic and family detriments which are peculiar to military service and which do not exist in normal civil life.'" *Johnson* v. *Robison*, 415 U. S. 361, 380 (1974) (emphasis deleted). Our country has a longstanding policy of compensating veterans for their past contributions by providing them with numerous advantages.[9] This policy has "always been deemed to be legitimate." *Personnel Administrator of Mass.* v. *Feeney*, 442 U. S. 256, 279, n. 25 (1979).

The issue in these cases is not whether TWR must be permitted to lobby, but whether Congress is required to provide it with public money with which to lobby. For the reasons stated above, we hold that it is not. Accordingly, the judgment of the Court of Appeals is

Reversed.

JUSTICE BLACKMUN, with whom JUSTICE BRENNAN and JUSTICE MARSHALL join, concurring.

I join the Court's opinion. Because 26 U. S. C. § 501's discrimination between veterans' organizations and charitable organizations is not based on the content of their speech, *ante*, at 548, I agree with the Court that § 501 does not deny charitable organizations equal protection of the law. The benefit provided to veterans' organizations is rationally based on the Nation's time-honored policy of "compensating veterans for their past contributions." *Ante*, this page. As the Court says, *ante*, at 548 and 550, a statute designed to discourage the expression of particular views would present a very different question.

I also agree that the First Amendment does not require the Government to subsidize protected activity, *ante*, at 546,

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[9] See, *e. g.*, *Personnel Administrator of Mass.* v. *Feeney*, 442 U. S. 256 (1979) (veterans' preference in civil service employment); *Johnson* v. *Robison*, 415 U. S. 361 (1974) (educational benefits).